# STANDARD OPERATING PROCEDURE (SOP)

# INTERNAL COMPLAINTS COMMITTEE (ICC) / POSH COMMITTEE

## 1. Purpose

The Standard Operating Procedure (SOP) defines the operational framework for the Internal Complaints Committee (ICC) / POSH Committee at Parivarthana Business School. The Committee is established to provide a safe, respectful and gender-sensitive environment, prevent and address sexual harassment, provide a confidential grievance redressal mechanism, conduct awareness programmes, and support compliance with the applicable Prevention of Sexual Harassment of Women at Workplace framework.

## 2. Scope

This SOP applies to:

- Women employees and faculty members
- Non-teaching and administrative staff
- Students
- Interns, trainees and other persons associated with the institution
- Contractual/temporary personnel and other persons covered by applicable institutional policy
- ICC/POSH Committee members and institutional authorities

## 3. Objectives

The ICC / POSH Committee shall:

1. Prevent and prohibit sexual harassment in the institutional/workplace environment.
2. Provide an accessible and confidential mechanism for receiving complaints.
3. Ensure fair, impartial and time-bound handling of complaints.
4. Protect the dignity, safety and privacy of persons approaching the Committee.
5. Conduct awareness and gender-sensitization programmes.

**4. Committee Composition**

| Sl. No. | Committee Member | Position | Signature |
|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Ms. Ramya V J | coordinator | |
| 2 | Ms. Sankranthi D | Member | |
| 3 | Ms. Tejaswini C K | Member | Tejaswini C K. |
| 4 | Ms. Preethi S | Member | |
| 5 | Ms. Manorathi L | Member | Manorathi. L. |
| 6 | Ms. Kruthika T S | Member | |
| 7 | Ms. Soumya Rajashekar | External Member | |

**5. Roles and Responsibilities**

**Presiding Officer**

- Provides leadership to the ICC and ensures that proceedings are conducted fairly and confidentially.
- Coordinates inquiry proceedings and Committee meetings.
- Ensures that statutory and institutional procedures are followed.
- Approves and forwards the Committee's recommendations and reports through the appropriate institutional authority.

**ICC Members**

- Participate in Committee meetings and inquiry proceedings.
- Examine complaints, statements, documents and other relevant evidence.
- Maintain confidentiality and impartiality.
- Assist in awareness and sensitization programmes.
- Support preparation of findings, recommendations and annual reports.

**Institutional Authority**

- Constitutes the Committee and provides necessary administrative support.
- Provides facilities required for conducting Committee activities.
- Considers and implements recommendations in accordance with applicable law and institutional rules.

## 6. Standard Operating Procedure

### Step 1: Constitution of Committee

- The ICC shall be constituted by an appropriate Office Order of the institution.
- The composition shall comply with the applicable statutory requirements.
- The Committee details and contact information shall be communicated/displayed appropriately.

Responsibility: Principal / Competent Institutional Authority

### Step 2: Planning

- Prepare an annual ICC/POSH activity plan.
- Schedule awareness and sensitization programmes.
- Review the availability of complaint-reporting channels.
- Plan periodic meetings and capacity-building activities for Committee members.

Responsibility: Presiding Officer / Coordinator

### Step 3: Receipt of Complaint

- Complaints may be submitted through the prescribed written or institutional complaint mechanism.
- Where required, reasonable assistance shall be provided for submitting the complaint.
- The complaint shall be recorded confidentially and acknowledged.
- A confidential complaint/reference number may be assigned for record purposes.

### Step 4: Preliminary Review

- Examine whether the matter falls within the jurisdiction of the Committee.
- Review the basic facts and available supporting material.
- Identify whether any immediate protective or interim measures are required.
- Do not prejudge the merits of the complaint.

### Step 5: Notice and Inquiry

- The respondent shall be informed of the allegations in accordance with the applicable procedure.
- The respondent shall be given a reasonable opportunity to submit a response.

- The Committee may record statements of the complainant, respondent and relevant witnesses.
- Relevant documents and other evidence may be examined as permitted.
- Minutes/proceedings shall be maintained confidentially.

**Step 6: Interim Measures**

- Where necessary, the Committee may recommend appropriate interim measures permitted under applicable law and institutional rules.
- Such measures shall be preventive/protective and shall not prejudge the outcome of the inquiry.

**Step 7: Inquiry Findings and Report**

- The Committee shall evaluate the material placed before it and record its findings.
- A reasoned inquiry report shall be prepared.
- Recommendations, where applicable, shall be forwarded to the competent institutional authority.
- The report and supporting records shall be handled confidentially.

**Step 8: Action Taken**

- The competent authority shall consider and implement recommendations in accordance with applicable law, service rules and institutional regulations.
- An Action Taken Report (ATR) shall be maintained for institutional records.

**Step 9: Awareness Programmes**

- POSH awareness and gender-sensitization programmes shall be organized.
- Students, faculty and staff shall be informed about the complaint mechanism and expected standards of conduct.
- ICC members shall receive appropriate orientation/capacity-building.

**Step 10: Annual Review**

- Review complaints handled, activities conducted and preventive measures undertaken.
- Prepare the required annual report.
- Identify recommendations for improving the institutional POSH mechanism.

## 7. Complaint Handling Timeline

| Activity | Timeline |
|---|---|
| Complaint Registration | On receipt / as prescribed |
| Acknowledgement & Preliminary Review | As early as practicable |
| Inquiry Proceedings | As per applicable statutory timeline |
| Inquiry Report | Within the statutory period |
| Action Taken Report | As per applicable institutional/statutory procedure |

## 8. Documents to be Maintained

1. Office Order constituting the ICC
2. Committee Member List and contact details
3. Meeting Notices and Agenda
4. Minutes of Meetings
5. Confidential Complaint Register
6. Complaint Forms and Acknowledgements
7. Notices / Responses / Statements, as applicable
8. Evidence and supporting documents, as applicable
9. Inquiry Reports
10. Action Taken Reports (ATR)
11. Awareness Programme Reports
12. Attendance and Feedback Records
13. Annual Reports and institutional submissions

## 9. Records Retention

| Record | Retention Period |
|---|---|
| Committee Orders | Permanent / as per institutional policy |
| Meeting Minutes | As per institutional records policy |
| Complaint and Inquiry Records | Confidential and as per applicable law/institutional policy |
| Action Taken Reports | As per institutional records policy |
| Annual Reports | Permanent / as per institutional policy |
| Awareness Programme Reports | As per institutional records policy |

## 10. Key Performance Indicators (KPIs)

- Number of ICC meetings conducted.
- Number of POSH awareness and sensitization programmes organized.
- Participation of students, faculty and staff in awareness programmes.
- Number of complaints received and disposed of in accordance with applicable procedure.
- Compliance with prescribed reporting and documentation requirements.
- Feedback on awareness and sensitization activities.
- Timely review and implementation of institutional preventive measures.

## 11. Compliance

The ICC / POSH Committee shall function in accordance with:

- The Sexual Harassment of Women at Workplace (Prevention, Prohibition and Redressal) Act, 2013, as applicable.
- Applicable Rules and Government notifications.
- University / affiliating authority regulations.
- UGC / AICTE and other applicable higher-education requirements.
- Karnataka State Government policies, where applicable.
- Institutional policies and quality-assurance requirements.

## 12. Confidentiality

- All complaints, inquiry proceedings, evidence and related records shall be treated as confidential.
- Identity and personal information shall not be disclosed except as permitted or required by applicable law.
- Committee members shall maintain impartiality, fairness and professional conduct.
- Records shall be stored securely with access restricted to authorized persons.

## Review and Amendment

The SOP shall be reviewed at least once every academic year or whenever required.

Amendments shall be made when there are changes in applicable law, rules, institutional regulations or operational requirements.

Revisions shall be approved by the competent institutional authority.

## Approval

| Prepared By | Reviewed By | Approved By |
|---|---|---|
| ICC / POSH Committee Coordinator<br>Name: | IQAC Coordinator<br>Name: | Principal<br>Dr. Raghunandhan G |